Table of Content

9.1 Introduction

9.2 Engineering Material

9.3 Classification of Materials and Properties

9.4 Mechanical Properties

9.5 Conducting Materials

9.6 Insulating Materials

9.7 Optical Materials

9.1 INTRODUCTION– PROPERTIES OF MATERIALS

A material is a substance used to make physical things. The term property means quality, which defines the specific characteristic of a material. Materials have different properties and characteristics depending on what they are used for. Examples of certain materials and their properties are given below.

Materials Properties

Pencil – Hard, Light, Opaque.
Window – Transparent, Brittle.
Paper – Light, Malleable.
Fork – Shiny, Hard, Conductor, Magnetic.



Figure 9.1 *Properties of Materials*

Do You Know?

Insulation works in both directions: if it is well insulated, a building is **more comfortable** whatever the season, warmer in winter and cooler in summer. It is therefore **more economical** as regards heating and air conditioning.

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